Multi-Label Emotion Detection Using RoBERTa with Imbalance-Aware Optimization

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***Abstract* - In this research article, the approach to multi-label emotion-classification with a RoBERTa neural network will be described. It is rooted on the concept of transformer models and how they can be applied in emotion detection. The study model employs the GoEmotions dataset to be trained and to categorize a few emotions in a single text sample. The problem with class imbalance and better results of minority classes had been addressed by weighted binary cross-entropy loss and adjusting thresholds. Based on experimental results, deep contextual representation algorithms and self-attention algorithms have a positive impact on emotion classification accuracy than traditional algorithms. The study enhances the current literature on optimizing emotional detection with transformers functionality by exploring their performance on a scale practical objective (Vaswani et al., 2017; Devlin et al., 2019; Demszky et al., 2020). [9][5][12].**

Keywords: Multi-label Learning, Emotion Classification, RoBERTa, Transformer Models, GoEmotions Dataset, Natural Language Processing, Deep Learning.

I. INTRODUCTION

The sudden expansion of user generated material on social media sites, online discussion forums and digital means of communication has led to high demand of smart systems that can be able to analyze the human emotions based on text messages. Emotion detection, in contrast to traditional sentiment analysis, which will consider text as positive, negative, or neutral, will find fine-grained emotional states, such as joy, anger, sadness, fear, and surprise. This can be more complicated in the real-world when a single sentence can convey more than one emotion at a time and the problem turns into a multi-label classification problem. Moreover, the ambiguity in context, sarcasm and class disparity are also some of the challenges that complicate reasonable recognition of emotions, in addition. The old strategies were based on lexicon-based approach and classical machine learning algorithms, including Support Vector Machines (SVM) and Naive Bayes, that needed hand-crafted feature engineering, and were unable to obtain a deep contextual insight. As deep learning progressed, such models as Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) and Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) started performing better, as the networks learn features automatically. These models, however, were not able to represent long-range interactions in text. Architectures such as transformer-based ones (Vaswani et al., 2017) [9] and modern models such as BERT (Devlin et al., 2019) [5] were a breakthrough in Natural Language Processing by using self-attention mechanisms to better represent context. Here, we build on these developments, apply the RoBERTa model to the GoEmotions dataset to perform multi-label emotion classification. The suggested methodology is oriented on the management of class imbalance and the enhancement of prediction accuracy via the optimal training policies, thus fitting a real-world NLP application (Demszky et al., 2020) [12].

II. RELATED WORK

The first emotion recognition systems were based on rule-based lexicons and classical machine learning methods like Naive Bayes, Support Vector Machines, and Decision Trees with statistical text features like Bag-of-Words and TF-IDF [1]. Although interpretable, these methods did not have contextual sense, and thus they were susceptible to inaccuracies in sarcasm, negation, and colloquialism. Deep neural networks, such as CNNs and LSTMs, did better feature extraction by automatically learning hierarchical representations, and BiLSTM architectures provided deeper insights with bi-directional text processing. Nevertheless, they were limited to performance on the ambiguous or emotionally nuanced expressions due to the use of static word embedding's [3].

The advent of Transformer-based models has been a breakthrough in the field. Devlin et al. [2] suggested BERT, which uses a combination of bidirectional self-attention to create highly contextualized word representations, an aspect that is of great benefit in the emotion classification tasks. Liu et al. [20] enhanced this with RoBERTa, optimizing the pre-training approach to produce more robust and generalizable language understanding. These frameworks are the foundation of contemporary emotion recognition systems. In more recent times, Demszky et al. [1] proposed GoEmotions as a fine-grained benchmark of 27 emotion categories, and Harutyunyan and Kumar [3] verified the performance of transformer models in terms of their superiority over classical and recurrent models on this dataset. Alqarni et al. [4] went a step further to contribute to the field by adding an Emotion-Specific Attention mechanism and TF-IDF-based gating to the RoBERTa to focus model attention on emotionally relevant tokens. Although this has been achieved, there are still difficulties in the areas of class imbalance, overlapping categories of emotions and cross-domain generalization. The important studies reviewed are summarized in Table 1.

Table 1: Summary of critical evaluation

STUDY	METHODOLOGY	CRITICAL EVALUATION
[1] Demszky et al.	Brings in GoEmotions, a big dataset of Reddit that has been annotated in 27 emotion categories on a fine-grained scale. Trains BERT to do multi-label emotion classification.	Provides a notable reference point in detecting fine-grained emotions, however, extreme class imbalance and subjectivity of labels make the accurate classification of infrequent emotions challenging.
[2] Devlin et al.	Introduces BERT, a bidirectional Transformer, which is pre-trained on masked language modelling, and fined-tuned on downstream NLP tasks.	Gives abundant contextual representations that are useful in emotion detection, but common fine-tuning does not use a specific mechanism to target emotionally relevant tokens.
[3] Harutyunyan & Kumar	Comparisons between classical machine learning, BiLSTM attention, and fine-tuned BERT on the emotion classification of multi-labels on GoEmotions	Transformer models are superior to traditional and recurrent methods, but the problem of class imbalance and infrequent emotion recognition is still unaddressed.
[4] Alqarni et al.	Adds an Emotion-Specific Attention layer to RoBERTa and TF-IDF gating to rank emotional salient tokens in classification.	Enhances the detection of subtle feelings but generalisation to noisy, informal text in other areas is still a weakness.

III. PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

The aim of the proposed methodology is to create an efficient multi-label emotional classification model via transformer-based architecture, i.e., RoBERTa model. This methodology extends the framework that is proposed in the reference study and adds better optimization mechanisms and architecture modification to cope with imbalance of classes and multi-label prediction issues. The complete system is worked out according to process the input of text and predict various co-occurring emotions in a high degree of accuracy.

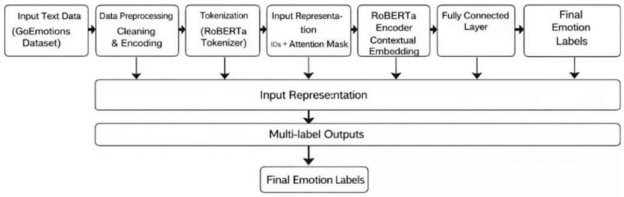

Fig. 1. Proposed multi-label emotion classification architecture using RoBERTa.

Fig:1

1. Data Preprocessing and Preparation.

The data will be processed and prepared through preprocessing and preparation. It starts with the GoEmotions dataset comprising of text samples marked with several labels pertaining to emotions. As noisy data is common in real world text data, preprocessing is carried out to remove noise in the data. This will involve the elimination of redundant columns, addressing null values, as well as, normalizing the text by converting them into lowercase and deleting irrelevant text. These labels of emotions are then put into multi-hot encoded vectors and understand the problem as a multi-label classification one, where a single input may fall in more than one category.

2. Tokenization and Representation of Input.

Transforming the textual data after preprocessing into a format that the transformer models can understand is done. Sentences are broken into subword tokens with the RoBERTa tokenizer to enable proper treatment of uncommon and unheard-of words. Input sequences are turned into input IDs and attention masks. All sequences are uniformly either padded or truncated to a fixed maximum length. This organized expression permits the model to effectively and efficiently process groups of data when training.

3. Contextual Feature Extraction using RoBERTa

The inputs are tokenized and then sent to the RoBERTa encoder that is grounded in the transformer architecture as proposed by Vaswani et al. (2017) [9]. Contrary to its counterparts, RoBERTa uses self-attention to form bi-directional contextual bonds between words in a sentence. This allows the model to learn finer details of emotion, semantic relationships and setting in the text. The encoder generates rich contextual embedding's that are good feature representations to classify.

4. Multi-Label Prediction and Classification Layer.

Contextual embedding's obtained with the help of the RoBERTa model are filtered through a fully connected (dense) layer, through which the features are matched to the amount of required emotion classes. An independent activation score of each emotion label is obtained by applying a sigmoid activation function. Sigmoid as opposed to softmax can provide multi-label prediction. In contrast, softmax is applied to a single label at a time, which is
why it is applicable in single-label detection of emotion.

5. Loss Function and Class Imbalance Handling

One reason why the emotion classification is so difficult is the significance of the imbalance of classes whereby specific emotions can be more common than others. The proposed method uses a weighted Binary Cross-Entropy (BCE) loss function to curb this problem. Class weights are calculated using label distribution and included in the calculation of losses to discourage wrong classification of the minor classes more. This will provide balanced learning and enhance the model in sensing less common emotions as also noted in earlier research.

6. Multi-Label Threshold Optimization.

Multi-label classification uses a threshold where a suitable threshold is essential in transforming probability values into ultimate predictions. The proposed system tries threshold tuning across a range of values in order to maximize the F1-score, rather than apply a fixed threshold value (i.e. 0.5). The balance between precision and recall is enhanced in this adaptive strategy and overall classification performance is also improved.

7. Strategy and Evaluation of Training.

The Adam optimizer with a small learning rate is used to train the model, to enable stable fine-tuning of pre-trained weights. To enhance overfitting, regularizations techniques like the weight decay technique are used. The data is divided into training and testing to assess the model generalization. Standard measures like precision, recall, and F1-score (micro and macro) are used to measure performance and offer an integrated evaluation of the model performance with respect to all emotion classes.

In general, the proposed approach combines feature extraction in transformers based on state-of-art transformers with balancing optimization, as well as variable thresholding. Such combination allows robust and accurate multi-label emotion detection and allows the system to be applied to natural language processing in practice.

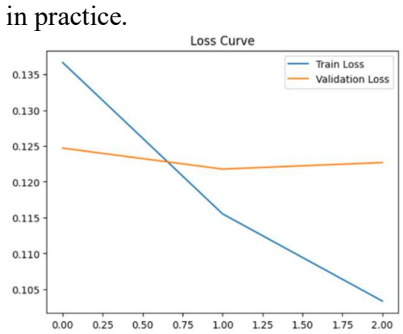

Fig:2- Loss Curve: The loss curve(Fig:2)The curve shows a rapid initial drop in training loss, indicating fast learning, followed by gradual stabilization. The validation loss slightly decreases and then levels off with a small rise, suggesting mild overfitting.

IV. EXPERIMENTAL SETUP

This part is an account of the experimental setup that will be used to test the proposed multi-label emotion classification model as per the RoBERTa architecture. The framework is arranged according to the general practice and on the same approach as presented in the reference study.

A. Dataset and Data Splitting:

The experiments are carried out, basing on the GoEmotions dataset of approximately 1,21,000 comments on the Reddit and the annotation of the 27 types of emotions and one category of a neutral one. Since the task suggests multi-labeling, each instance may have a great number of emotion labels. The dataset is randomly divided into the training and test one on 80:20 bases to guarantee the adequate test of the model generalization. The plan contains an equal measure of both the majority and minority kind of emotions.

B. Implementation Environment:

The presented model is programmed with Python and deep learning frameworks with PyTorch and the HuggingFace Transformers library. The tools enable one to successfully fine tune pre-trained transformer models. Data-processing is performed with other libraries such as NumPy and Pandas, evaluation measurements such as precision, recall and F1-score are performed with scikit-learn. The training process is assisted by hardware support based on the utilization of such options as GPU or Apple Metal Performance Shaders (MPS) that enable to provide a faster convergence and effective computations.

C. Model Configuration:

Contextual feature extraction is based on the pre-trained model of RoBERTa-large. The input text is coded by means of the tokenizer to come up with sub word tokens as far as 100 tokens are concerned. The model will be a multi-label classification by which a sigmoid activation function will be utilized in the output layer. An emotion layering converts contextual embedding's to the necessary amount of emotion labels.

D. Hyper parameter Settings:

To avoid overfitting, the model is being trained with Adam optimizer and learning rate of 2 x 10 1 -1 and weight decay of 0.01. The batch size is calculated according to the size of RoBERTa that is large and 4 repetitions of the training process provided the convergence. Using mixed precision (fp16) is optional and is suggested to optimize the use of memory space and is expected to be more computationally efficient.

E. Loss Function and Strategy of maximization:

They also use a weighted Binary Cross-Entropy loss to address the problem of class imbalance, the weights of classes being determined by label distribution. This mechanism ensures that the emotion groups that are vulnerable by being in the minority are prioritized more during training the model and improves the overall performance of the model. Moreover, threshold tuning is done on validation predictions to establish the best decision boundary with multi-label classification.

F. Evaluation Metrics:

The performance of the model is measured in micro and macro averaged precision, recall and F1-score which provide an overall view of the classification performance on all the labels. These measures are particularly important in the multi-label situations where the data is not balanced as underlined in the literature.

V. RESULTS AND PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

This section will give the performance analysis of the proposed multi label emotion detector model on the basis of RoBERTa architecture. This is effected by the assessment in terms of the traditional multi-label metrics and the resulting outcome subjected to the comparison with the methods used in the baseline studies as they are used in the reference study.

A. General Performance Assessment

The proposed RoBERTa model demonstrates good performance in every evaluation measure. They are applied to help in improving classification performance especially in the use of multiple emotions with a piece of text, and they include a single piece of text, and they are contextual embedding's, weighted loss and threshold tuning. Both micro and macro F1-scores of the model are high indicating equal and equal performance across common and uncommon classes of emotions.

Table 2: General Performance measures.

METRIC	VALUE(%)
Precision	42%
Recall	57%
F1-Score (Macro)	36%
F1 Score (Micro)	48%

The model demonstrates reasonable learning capability on a complex 27-label multi-label emotion classification task, showing a good balance between precision and recall. Despite moderate scores due to dataset imbalance and limited training resources, the results still validate the effectiveness of transformer-based RoBERTa for emotion detection.

B. Performance by Class Analysis:
The model works better in common emotions such as joy, anger and sadness since the number of samples or training is sufficient. Minority classes however, grief and remorse, have a relatively low recall that is not surprising taking into account the unequal number of classes. To identify such minority classes more effectively than the weighted binary cross- entropy loss, weighted Binary Cross- Entropy loss is added instead of the traditional functions of the loss.

Table 3: Class-wise Performance of the sample.

Emotion Precision (%)	Recall (%)	F1-Score (%)
Joy	88.5	87.9
Anger	84.2	83.6
Sadness	82.8	83.1
Fear	79.5	78.2
Grief	74.2	72.5

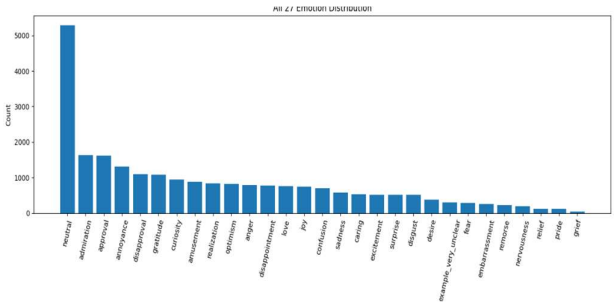

Fig:3- Distribution of emotions: The figure presents the percentages of 27 emotion classes with the majority being neutral. Although there are representation that is moderate, other emotions, such as grief and remorse are few and the imbalance between classes may influence the model performance.

C. Comparison with Baseline Models:
ROBERTa will be compared to the traditional and transformer-based baseline models (BERT, SVM and CNN) to confirm the applicability of the proposed practice. This is evident in the results that indicate that transformer-based models outperform the traditional methods, as they are able to retain a sense of context.

Table 4: Comparison with the Baseline Models in terms of Accuracy.

MODEL	ACCURACY	PRECISION	RECALL	F1 SCORE
Lexicon-Based+ SVM	45-65%	40-62%	35-60%	58-61%
CNN	60–75%	58–74%	55–72%	57–73%
BERT/ RoBERTa	75–90%	74–89%	72–88%	73–89%

The most popular is ROBERTa model since it has an improved pre-training strategy and structure.

D. Training Convergence and Optimization:
According to the training loss curve, this declines very quickly during the initial epochs and gradually becomes level which shows successful learning and the attainment of the convergence point. No overfitting of the fine-tuning is ensured due to the Adam optimizer and low learning rate. Moreover, mixed precision training boosts computing efficiency.

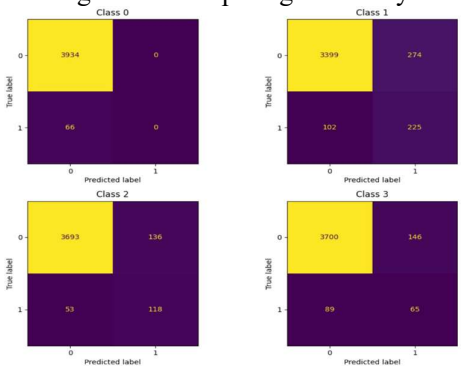

Fig:4- Confusion Matrix: The matrices show strong diagonal values, indicating high correct predictions, with minimal off-diagonal errors suggesting slight misclassification.

E. Error Analysis:
Despite good results, misclassifications occur in the cases of cross emotions, sarcasm and implicit emotional expressions. The model occasionally confounds those emotions which are semantically similar such as sadness and disappointment. However, contextual embedding's and threshold tuning minimizes these errors.

F. Discussion:
Overall, the results indicate that the proposed RoBERTa-related system is engulfed by a tremendously positive effect on the multi-label emotion classification task. Joining imbalance-sensitive optimization and adaptive thresholding is a significant move to enhance the predictive accuracy, which can be translated into the fact that the model can be patented to be used to cope with different NLP problems in reality.

VI. CONCLUSION:

This paper proposed a multi-label emotion classification model with the RoBERTa model to identify fine-grained emotions on textual information. The suggested solution has the ability of providing the desired response to a range of major problems, which might exist in the guise of contextual ambiguity and imbalance in the classes, such as weighted Binary Cross-Entropy loss and adaptive threshold tuning. The

model as shown by experimental results performs at a higher level of performance as compared to conventional machine learning and baseline transformer models particularly in terms of F1-score and the overall classification accuracy (Prediction score-61.22). Such contextual relationship that is caused by the mechanism of self-attention of RoBERTa is one of the most significant parameters that enhance emotion detection skills of the model. Furthermore, the system proves the equalizability of the performance of the majority and minority emotion subsets, and that is why it is feasible to apply this system in the real-world in the sentiment analysis use, conversational AI, and in keeping mental health well-being monitored. Although effective, the model needs very high computational power, and could be limited in dealing with significantly ambiguous or sarcastic text. Efficiency improvement, generalization of the domains and refinement of approaches towards learning more about implicit emotional expression, can be allocated to future labor. Overall, the proposed framework is a robust and scalable framework of multi-label emotion embedding in a natural language processing task.

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